• AD TECH SHIFT

Apple explains why Safari blocks identity graphs

Hashed emails replaced third-party cookies. Now Apple is cutting them off too.

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The target is email tracking

When users sign up for newsletters or log in, tech vendors convert email addresses into cross-site IDs. Apple wants that pipeline severed.

- Applies to Safari on iOS and macOS
- Includes Vision Pro headsets
- Blocks entire vendor web addresses

03

Major identity providers hit first

Apple rolled out the block in its September update. Several market leaders in alternative identifiers were cut off immediately.

- LiveRamp, ID5 and Permutive blocked
- Audigent and UID 2.0 affected
- Ad servers risked accidental blocks

04

Why Apple intervened now

People keep email addresses for years across all devices. Apple argued that building cross-site identity profiles goes far beyond user expectations.

- Unsubscribing does not delete vendor IDs
- Profiles grow with every form fill
- Firms link people across unrelated sites

05

First-party data vs outside matchers

Sites can still personalize content for their own direct audience. The block specifically targets third parties hired to match that data across other domains.

- Internal recommendations remain safe
- External identity graphs are blocked
- Publishers face audience valuation risks

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86 open roles in Apple Ads

Apple is hiring heavily for ad engineering and campaign management as it restricts outside tracking.

RECAP

Key takeaways for marketers

- Safari blocks hashed email tracking
- Major identity vendors are shut out
- First-party site data stays intact
- Apple Ads continues rapid expansion

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Review your identity stack today

Follow for clear digital growth breakdowns. How will this Safari block impact your current ad targeting?

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